

» CLOSER LOOK

There are three mechanisms of balance: inner ear, visual, and proprioceptive input. Warrior III challenges each of these systems, improving your dynamic balance as you enter the pose and static balance while you hold it.

Visual cortex processes sensory information

Optic nerve carries information to back of brain

Eye

Visual input

“Drishti” is the yoga term for a focal point, which can help with both balance and concentration. Softly focus on a single stationary point ahead of you. You can also experiment with closing your eyes for a few moments—you will quickly realize how much your visual input contributes to your balance.

Torso comes as close toward parallel to the ground as comfortable

Hip extensors engage and lengthen

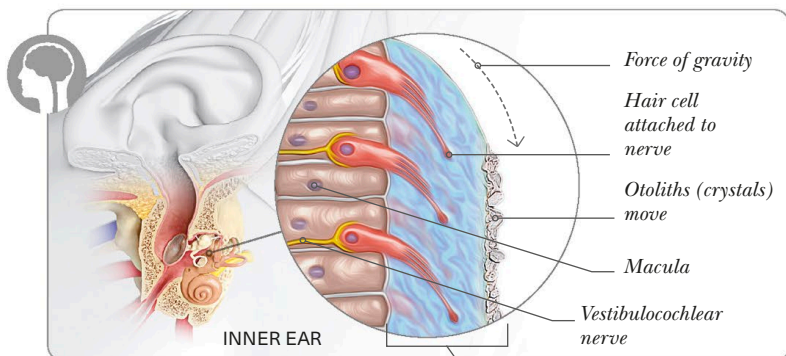
Quadriceps engage strongly

Kneecap faces forward

Tibialis anterior engages to maintain balance

Toes spread out and relaxed

ANTERIOR VIEW



Inner ear input

Your inner ear has a bony labyrinth of tunnels filled with fluid to regulate your equilibrium or balance. When your head changes orientation, the fluid pushes on sensitive hair cells. Attached nerves tell your brain which direction your head is moving, to adjust for balance.

Otolithic membrane contains gelatinous fluid